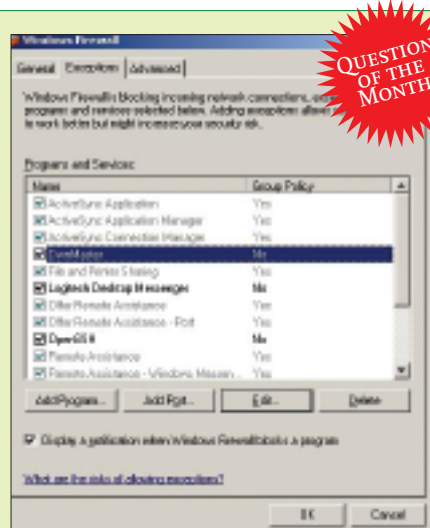


Torrents aren't working on the laptop

Q Hi, I have this laptop in which torrent downloads have been blocked. Please guide me through the procedures to unblock it. Thanks!

A Check your system firewall by clicking on Start > Settings > Control Panel > Windows Firewall. Go to Exceptions and check your torrent download client. If you have any other firewall program, then allow access through that software in the same manner.

Jagdeep Viridi
(TECH QNA Expert)



Exceptions for uTorrent maybe required to ensure open access for it

QUESTION OF THE MONTH

Does this configuration lead to CPU bottlenecks and can be improved by expanding the RAM size? Please suggest me a way to get rid of these problems.

Chayan

A The problem with DVDs not reading could be due to the drive detecting that make of media. The fix for that could be flashing the firmware. Go to the manufacturer's site and download the latest BIOS for the exact same model of DVD drive you own.

The problem of not being able to install software is bizarre. Make sure your Windows account is not set up as a limited user. Try creating a new user. If the installer for the software is corrupted somehow, then that could also be causing the problems.

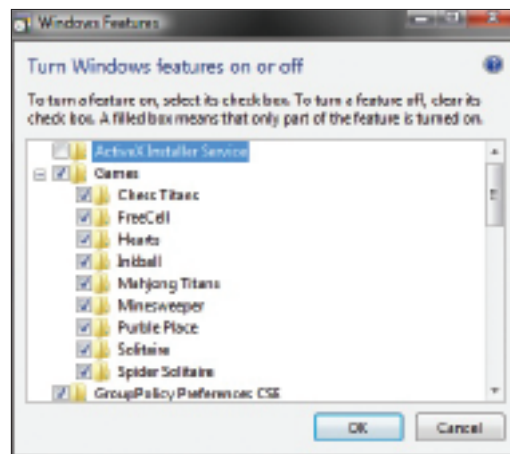
Try updating drivers for your graphics solution on the motherboard to fix the problem of games blanking out the screen when run. 1 GB of memory is sufficient for Windows XP to run but upgrading to a minimum of 2 GB is recommended anyway. You will find improvement in performance. A dedicated graphics card for games is also recommended.

Using other programs instead of default programs

Q I use Windows Vista as my operating system. I use other programs instead of some of the default programs that come with it like Notepad, Paint, Internet Explorer, Calculator, Windows Explorer, etc. I use Textpad, Paint.net, Firefox, DreamCalc 3 Pro and Total Commander respectively; I want to get rid of these default programs.

Is there a way?

Vikas Mahindra



Turning on and off of some of Windows Vista's components is possible

A You cannot uninstall all of the mentioned software from your Windows Vista installation but you can remove a few of them. Software like Windows Explorer and Internet Explorer are vital to the operating system in some ways or for software that you might install in the future.

To uninstall the few selected software, click on Start > Control Panel > Programs and Features. In the left panel, click on Turn Windows features On or Off. Here you can remove some of the software that come with Vista.

I want to dual boot XP and Vista

Q I want to install Windows Vista over my existing installation of XP. Can I just install Vista in another drive? Will it work properly? I have read many books on it but I didn't understand properly. Please help.

This is my system configuration
Processor: Intel Pentium 2.66GHz
512 MB of RAM
Intel 82865G integrated graphics card
80 GB SATA hard drive
I am currently running Windows XP SP3

Rajshekhar Sirimala

A Installing Vista over XP will not be a problem at all. Simply insert the Vista DVD on system startup after you have set your DVD drive as the bootable device. All you need is a different partition. Just be sure to choose which one carefully and do not format it if you have any data on it. Once that's done, Vista will install and changes will be made to the boot record so you can choose between the two operating systems every time you boot.

System has slowed down

Q I am a regular reader of Digit. It is the one and only one tech magazine which always keeps me up to date. I have a problem with my desktop computer. My PC Configuration is:

Intel P4 processor 2.4 GHz, Gigabyte 845 Motherboard, 256 MB DDR1 RAM and 1 GB DDR1 RAM. I also have a 40GB HDD and a 160GB (IDE) OS Windows XP SP2

The problem is very critical. I was running my PC very well with 256 MB RAM and 40 GB and 160 GB HDD. Last week, my system performance dropped by a lot. Even a simple application takes a lot of time to load.

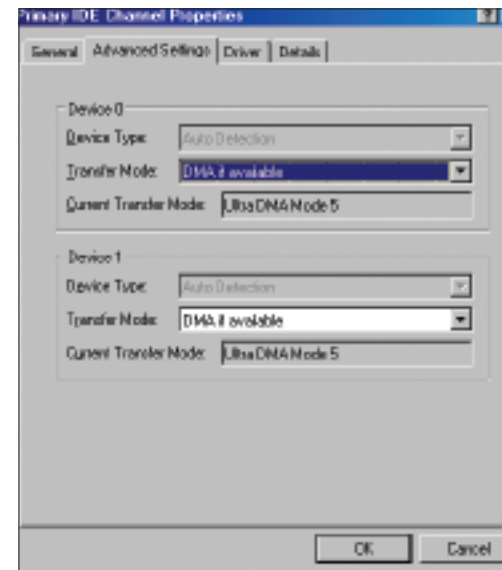
1. I tried installing a new OS with different different CDs - no results.
2. I upgraded my memory with 1 GB DDR1 with some good results, but my CPU usage reaches 100% even with small applications, or while installing some software. Even if I open a folder, the CPU utilization reaches to 90% for six to seven seconds.
3. I tried changing power supply - no results
4. I tried installing OS in another HDD - no results
5. Both fans are working well, CPU as well as the power supply.
6. The CPU temperature is 44C

No vendor of my city could solve the problem. What do you suggest?

Sandeep Goyal

A One of the first things to do is to update the drivers for your motherboard. If you've just added the 1 GB of RAM, plug out the older 256 MB and look for any improvement. The CPU temperature is perfectly fine. If you have two drives connected, try discon-

Enabling DMA mode for the hard drive channel



necting the one without the operating system to look for any improvements. If that works, then you know one of the drives might be faulty. Also, enable DMA for the hard drives from the Windows Device Manager.

Digit! Please help! Booting issue!

Q Hello Digit, I bought a new rig after a week of detailed research on the Internet and your magazine. Here is the config I got.

Intel Core 2 Duo E7300 2.66 GHz
MSI P7NGM DIGITAL Motherboard
Palit Radeon HD 4870 SONIC 1GB Dual Edition (with Dual BIOS)
Seagate Barracuda 7200.11 HDD 320 GB
Corsair 2 x 2 GB 800MHz RAM
Cooler Master extreme Power 600W PSU
Cooler Master CM 690 Cabinet
Dell E1909W 19-inch LCD
Liebert Emerson 600VA UPS

I installed Windows XP SP2 and Vista with SP1. From the very first day, whenever I switch on my PC, the motherboard logo flashes on screen and then a strange three second beep can be heard from the cabinet. Immediately after that, the system hangs completely. I reinserted the RAM but the problem persists. The strange thing is when I restart my PC, it still gives me that strange sound but it boots properly and I can login into both XP and Vista and even can play Crysis at very high resolution for 10 hours at a stretch without any problems.

I would like to mention here that my huge graphics card has physically covered almost all the six SATA ports on my motherboard and the HDD SATA port was connected with very much difficulty. I even had to keep the entire cabinet in a lying down position as in the upright position my graphics card was literally throwing its whole weight on the HDD SATA port below and giving me display-related problems.

Is my graphics card clashing with my motherboard somehow? Or otherwise, is my SMPS not powerful enough? The box for the Graphics card says it alone needs 500 W Power Supply.

Please help me as I'm going nearly crazy and lost all my sleep and peace of mind.

Amitava Das

A If the graphics card manufacturer states that 500W is required for just the graphics card alone, then the power supply is most likely the problem. Make sure that you have all the necessary power cables plugged in. If possible, borrow a powerful PSU from one of your friends and try starting up your PC. If your graphics card isn't properly fitting into the PCI-E slot, then unplug the SATA cables and see if you have any beeps or errors during startup.

Buzzing sound

Q Hello, I get a buzzing noise when I move my mouse pointer on the screen. The sound is an odd static which comes from the speakers. I have an Enter optical mouse. Please tell me what to do to fix this problem. My rig configuration is an